

Burnham Market Primary School Visit Report

Audit Date: 05/02/2020

Report: Year 2 visit 1

DPE: Stuart Lee

School member: Gemma Fitzpatrick

1. Visit details

The focus of the visit was to complete an awareness session with Gemma Fitzpatrick (new office manager). This included an audit walk where I was able to talk with the headteacher and class teachers.

The focus of the awareness session was to give a brief overview of the DPE website, including the different online training options, an overview of GDPR in practice (using the DPE best practice guide) and how this is applied in school, with the main issues to be aware of. In addition, Gemma was signposted to the online training.

Audit walk findings

It was evident that staff were aware of their GDPR responsibilities and good GDPR practice was observed; forename only used for lists and displays; secure confidential waste and teaching staff know of their responsibilities in securing sensitive files when not in use. The front office was well organised with robust procedures/routines in place for data handling. It was noted and discussed that as the office is accessed by parents, staff need to be constantly vigilant regarding data that is being worked on and displayed.

The DPE best practice guide was handed out and it was suggested this be displayed in the staffroom: <https://kb.dataprotection.education/best-practice-library/documents/drip-feeds/20-how-do-you-keep-your-data>

Visitor signing in system

The school uses Inventory as its confidential visitor signing in system. The front office is situated way from the signing in system. There was no reference to the Trusts Privacy Notice.

- **Advisory:** Add information at reception to inform visitors where they can access the school's privacy statement from i.e. school website (not discussed during visit).

Front office

Staff were proactive in their GDPR compliance. Areas were tidy and staff were vigilant to the fact that the office is used as a 'dropping off' point for staff and parents with school correspondence. Good routines were observed and discussed; office staff ensure PCs were locked when not present; minimising data on display; ensuring in-trays are empty and securing sensitive files; the student contact folder is added to secure storage at night and doors are locked.

Parental access increases the risk to a parent/visitor viewing or accessing sensitive data. There is a mini hatch where visitors could potentially view the PC screen.

Main risks being:

- Pigeonholes are placed just inside the office and contained sensitive data;
- Monitors could potentially be viewed by parents/visitors;
- Interruptions to staff could result in sensitive data being displayed openly;
- Parents/visitors accessing the office viewing sensitive data;

Action points/considerations:

Review to take place of current set up to include;

- Limiting access to parents/visitor's for example: Could a 'post box' or similar secure area be created outside the office where parents can post any correspondence to, rather than entering the office?
- Teacher operates a tray system, this could be used for teacher/office communications but the school would need to be aware of the risk of sensitive data being left in teacher trays;
- Ensure pigeonholes are checked regularly and avoid adding sensitive data to pigeonholes or relocating pigeon holes to a more secure location;
- Review of PC monitor position that faces the mini hatch;
- Consider if the office would benefit from keycode entry.

Classrooms

Not all classrooms had secure storage. All staff spoken to have a good awareness of GDPR and what was and was not sensitive data. Staff confirmed that sensitive SEND folders were added to secure storage. School is moving more towards online systems. Lists and displays, including lists in folders which were observed mainly contained forename only.

Photocopier

Gemma confirmed that she is investigating adding secure printer codes to the photocopier.

Headteachers office

The headteacher was not in the room when first entered. PC/laptop was locked and no sensitive data was observed when checking through folders and looking at data being worked on. Headteacher confirmed that GDPR awareness i.e. locking PC/laptop and securing sensitive folders was being embedded in school.

- **Advisory:** Consider if the office would benefit from keycode entry.

Staffroom

1x meeting minutes folder with outdated information and staff birthday list displayed - ascertained this was not needed, list was removed during the visit.

- **Action point:** continue reminding staff to check folders and cleanse to remove outdated information.

Cupboard/storeroom

Room is used for archiving data and is also used as a storeroom. The room contained an excessive amount of data and required a cleanse. Data can easily be lost or left and become outdated. Gemma is aware of this and the need for the school to complete a data cleanse.

- **Advisory:** Raise awareness of the Trust's retention schedule and complete a data cleanse of the cupboard.

ICT Room

The room contained the school server which was positioned in the corner on the floor.

- **Advisory:** The school server would benefit by having a secure case to improve security or position server in a more secure location.